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or Kolkata-based Sanjiv Goenka, Chairman of the RP-Sanjiv Goenka Group, a business

should throw up either cash flows or valuations to justify it being part of one's portfolio. In an interview with *Business Today's* Global Business Editor **Udayan Mukherjee, he decodes what has worked for his businesses. Edited excerpts:**

Q: Sanjiv, your group's interests are so diverse—from old-age businesses like power, energy, carbon black, extending to a suite of new generation enterprises like FMCG, retail, entertainment, music and IT. How do you keep a handle on such disparate businesses without getting torn in too many directions?

A: Three points I would like to make, Udayan: one, all the businesses have critical mass and they lead in terms of operational efficiencies in the industries that they operate in. So, because of their efficiencies, each one of them has earned the right to grow. Two, we have very strong, and very capable management teams with each of the companies who pretty much run the day-to-day businesses on their own so they come to me by exception. Three, we have a very robust system of reporting so we have reviews which happen very frequently and the reviews are broken into two parts—one is the operations review and one is the review of the new initiatives. So if you know how to focus, you actually land up with time on your hands.

Q: You know parents like to say that all their children are equal but life teaches us that's not exactly true. So, among all these children of yours, these businesses, are there some which are closer to your heart than others?

A: Not really, none. At the end of the day, you may enjoy some more and you may enjoy some less, but that doesn't mean anything as long as the business throws up either cash flows or valuations such that it makes sense to have it in your portfolio. In business, one has to be dispassionate in evaluation.

Q: That's an interesting line so let me pick up on that—cash flow or valuations. The one which has been the serious wealth creator in your fold is the music business of Saregama. It always had a wealth of assets and the library was second to none, but it's only in the last two or three years that you really started realising the value embedded in it. Do you think this is the cusp of the monetisation wave and as streaming becomes more and more powerful you will be able to unlock true value for this business in a way which you couldn't have done 5-7 years ago?

A: Absolutely. I think Saregama has completely re-invented itself in terms of the approach, in terms of being completely with it—in terms of technology, in terms of developments, in terms of leading from the front, in terms of getting back to the acquisition of repertoire. Carvaan was one of the biggest technological marvels where you actually have a digital product, presented and made simple enough and accessible for an older-generation audience. So, we felt it should not be intimidating for people over 45. It should be simple to use and yet digitally and technologically savvy. It's this kind of thought process, this kind of innovation that's driving the company. So, of course, streaming helps enormously but I think it's a series of things, not a one off.

“I do believe this [the IPL] is a huge value creation opportunity because in 5-7 years, I expect these franchises to be valued at \$2 billion at least”

Q: It's true that Saregama is more than just Carvaan. The kind of licensing deals you did with Spotify a while back or your foray into the OTT spectrum with medium- and low-budget movies, it seems like Saregama is positioning itself as a larger entertainment company rather than just a Carvaan-focussed direct music company.

A: Yes, we are content providers and we are entertainment providers. Music is one element; we had many more plans which got put on hold because of Covid-19. But, hopefully, they will now be put into action. I can